Sample essay

By Haley, a student. As you read, **underline or highlight anything you find interesting:** at least one thing in every paragraph.

Bored in the USA: How Lack of Creativity in Schools Hurts Students and Teachers

Do you remember trying to learn how to ride a bike? It was exciting, blood rushing, and challenging, but worth it. When you got going but fell, you got back up and went a little further each time. You had more motivation to keep going because it was exciting. Schools today seem to lack this sense of excitement. Students have zero motivation to keep going because there is no excitement from the teachers and no sense of an end goal for the students. Shouldn't the process of learning be inspiring and exciting for everyone? When schools fail to prioritize creativity in teaching, school becomes boring for both students and teachers, resulting in a lack of shared motivation, excitement, and accomplishment.

Visit most schools in America today and you'll see how much creativity they really lack. Handouts, tests, and managing student behavior seem to be the priorities. Many teachers think if they allow creativity in a classroom, it will cause the students to be disruptive, and make it hard to gain control again. Administrators may also be to blame, if they don't see the value of creative activities and discourage teachers from teaching in this way. However, the truth is that creative activities get students interested in subjects. When they are interested, they ask questions and want to learn more. In some cases, they may even find the thing they want to focus on in college or for a career.

The fact is, when students are not inspired creatively, they get bored. Have you ever walked into a classroom and seen students asleep? What about teachers who never get out of their seats to teach? This is very common in classrooms today. Students aren't interested in the lessons because the teacher shows no signs of interest either. A lot of the time teachers just slap a packet of worksheets on students' desks and tell them to do it. This does not sufficiently challenge them or encourage them. According to "The 74," a nonprofit news organization covering American education, thirty-two percent of American students say they feel bored during class (www.the74million.org). They feel unconnected and unmotivated with the lessons. This affects teachers too, who also show signs of boredom by having a low monotone voice, never changing their teaching routine, and always being serious. This collective boredom between students and teachers makes school painful, when it could be energizing.

The issue at hand is the lack of shared motivation, excitement, and accomplishment among the teachers and students. Walking into a classroom today, especially after the pandemic, everyone seems so drained and unmotivated. Students got so used to learning everything through a screen for 2 years. Now all you see is students on their phones or asleep. This also severely affects teachers because they feel that there is no hope in teaching students while battling the students' desire to constantly be connected with social media. Furthermore, many teachers appear to be disengaged with the students and even their profession. To remedy this, administrators should support teachers in teaching creatively. Projects instead of tests, fun activities instead of worksheets, and physical movement instead of sitting still can make class more engaging and fun. Not only would this increase student involvement, but it would also help teachers rediscover their love for teaching again. Making learning fun truly motivates everyone.

If we assume that teachers don't like to be boring, then why doesn't the education system teach them how to prioritize creative thinking in classrooms? Perhaps the way teachers are taught today is wrong. They put too much pressure on teachers to increase scores, and this trickles down to the students, and suddenly everything we do in school is about "the test." No one can learn under those conditions. However, if administrators and teachers prioritized creative lessons, we could build engagement and excitement between the teachers and students. Imagine the impact this could have on student learning and the teaching profession!